GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

Sessions 6 – 7- Student Guide

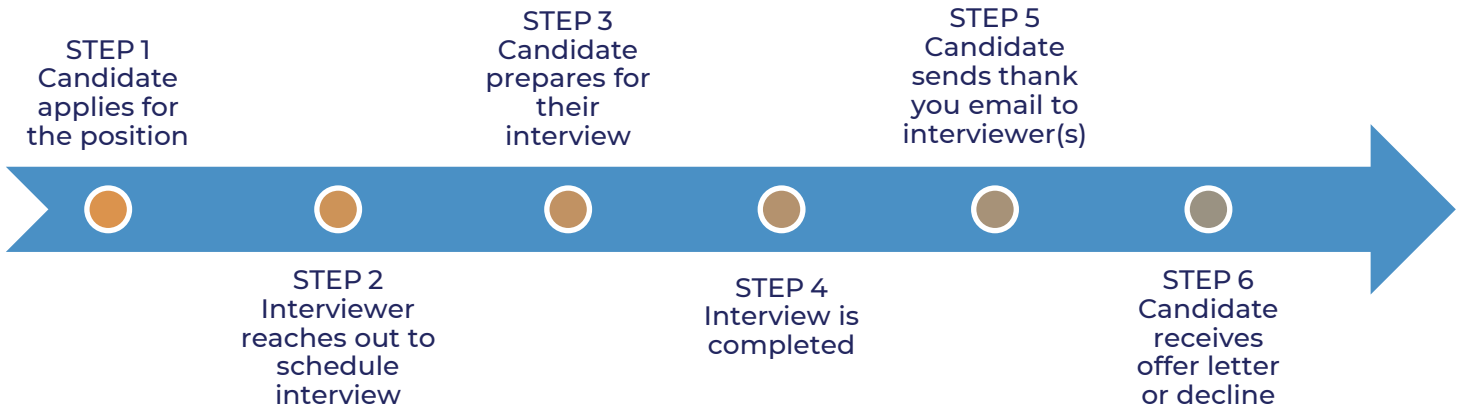
The Job Interview



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The Interview Process



Most Common Types of Interview

- ✓ Telephone Screening
- ✓ Skills Competency Test
- ✓ Traditional One-On-One
- ✓ Panel
- ✓ Video Conference
- ✓ Behavioral

Less Common Types of Interview

- ✓ Lunch
- ✓ AI Interview
- ✓ Peer Group
- ✓ Work Sample
- ✓ Working Interview
- ✓ Reverse

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Types of Interviews

	Telephone Screening	One to One Interview	Panel Interview
What is it?	✓ This is a common first step to the interview process where an interviewer will set a specific date and time to complete a screening over the phone with a candidate. ✓ The telephone screening will assess whether the candidate's qualifications match the position, if their expected salary can be accommodated, and if the candidate should be asked to come in for an in-person interview for further evaluation.	✓ The Interviewer will set a date and time for the candidate to come to the office and complete a one-on-one, in-person or a virtual interview. ✓ The interviewer will usually be a manager or supervisor for the position.	✓ The Interviewer will set a date and time for the candidate to have a virtual or in person interview with 3 or more interviewers. ✓ The interviewers will be a mix of managers, supervisors, and colleagues for the position in which the candidate is applying.
Benefits	✓ This type of interview takes less time and resources than an in-person interview, therefore allows the organization to interview many candidates quickly.	✓ A one-to-one interview allows the interviewer to get to know the candidate better and ask more specific questions related to the job.	✓ Panel interviews allow multiple interviewers with different perspectives on the position to ask questions they feel are pertinent in assessing a candidate for the position.
Tips	✓ Be ready to take the call 15 minutes prior to scheduled start time. ✓ Find a quiet place with no distractions where you will not be interrupted. ✓ Have a pen and paper ready to take notes during the call. ✓ Have your resume handy in case the interviewer asks you questions. ✓ Smile while answering questions so that your responses come across more positive.	✓ Bring a copy of your resume and a pen and paper to take notes. ✓ Be sure your cell phone is on silent and stored away or avoid bringing it altogether. ✓ Use a positive, confident tone of voice. ✓ Sit up straight with your feet planted on the ground in front of you. ✓ Maintain good eye contact with the interviewer. ✓ Remember the interviewers name and use it when addressing them.	✓ Bring at least 7 copies of your resume to the interview so you have enough copies for all the interviewers plus a few extras. ✓ Use a positive, confident tone of voice. ✓ Interact with each individual interviewer at least once during the interview. ✓ Focus on the interviewer asking questions and make eye contact when answering their question. ✓ Try to remember all the interviewer's names and use them. ✓ Ask for business cards from everyone on the panel so that you can thank them individually for taking the time to consider your application.

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How to Prepare for an Interview

Research the Company

What projects are they working on? What programs do they currently have in place? Who is their target market? What other organizations do they work with? What are their mission, values, and culture?

Study the Job Description Carefully

- It is important to fully understand the job. Identify the key skills and responsibilities. Prepare examples that show you can do the job.

Understand the Minimum Qualifications

- Do you meet the minimum qualifications? If you do not, and you still get an interview, explain how your other experience makes up for this.

Practice Questions

- Learn and understand the different types of interview questions and their purpose. Practice answering sample questions beforehand.

Dress Professionally

- Blazer, button up shirt, slacks, knee-length skirt or dress, closed-toed shoes, and simple jewelry and accessories, nothing flashy.

- Do not wear dresses or skirts that are too short, revealing neck lines, or clothing with holes or stains.

Be Kind and Professional

- Be kind and professional to everyone you interact with in the organization: the doorman, the security guard, the receptionist, etc.

Arrive Early

- Always arrive about 10 minutes early. Then find a place to sit and review your notes. If it is a virtual interview, be sure to connect 5 minutes early to ensure you are set up and connected.

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Questions to Ask During the Interview

Why is this Important?

Preparing questions ahead of time shows the interviewer that you took the time to research the position and their organization and that you are interested in learning more.

Asking the right questions will also allow you to learn important information about the organization, the role, and may even determine whether you accept the offer or not.

What to do First

Before asking your questions, ask the interviewer if you have sufficiently answered all of their questions or if they would like additional details on anything you have discussed.

Finding the Right Questions to Ask

Use the research you have done on the organization and the job description to help narrow down your questions specific to each individual position in which you are applying for.

Best Practices

It is wise to have at least five questions prepared ahead of time. Often one or more of the questions will be answered earlier in the interview, therefore it is helpful to have multiple questions prepared.

Examples

- ✓ What will the first three weeks be like?
- ✓ What kind of training will I receive to prepare for the job?
- ✓ What kinds of projects would I be working on during the first six months?
- ✓ How would you describe the management style of this team/overall organization?
- ✓ Who do you think would be an ideal candidate for this position?
- ✓ How is performance for this position measured and reviewed?
- ✓ What does success look like in the first 90 days?
- ✓ How would you describe the company's culture?
- ✓ What do you enjoy most about working here?
- ✓ What have past employees done to be successful in this role?
- ✓ If you were to hire me, what might I expect in a typical day?
- ✓ What kinds of staff development opportunities are available for this position?

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After the Interview

At the End of the Interview

Get Business Cards

- ✓ Request a business card or email from all the interviewers.
  - ✓ Doing so will provide you with the correct spelling of their names and an e-mail address for follow up.
  - ✓ If the interviewer does not have a business card, ask the receptionist for the correct spelling of the interviewer's name.

End Professionally

- ✓ In person interview
  - ✓ End the interview with a firm handshake.
  - ✓ Smile and maintain eye contact
- ✓ Virtual interview
  - ✓ Smile and maintain eye contact with camera
  - ✓ Wait for the interviewer to end the call
  - ✓ Avoid abruptly clicking “Leave meeting”
- ✓ Genuinely thank the interviewer(s) for taking time to meet with you and for considering you for the position.
- ✓ The interviewer will associate positivity and confidence when thinking back to your interview.

After the Interview

Immediately Send Thank-You Note

- ✓ Send a thank-you letter, by email, to the interviewer(s) within 24 hours
- ✓ Be sure to get the correct spelling of their names.

If No Response Within One Week

- ✓ If you have not heard anything from the interviewer(s) after one week, send an email following up from the interview to see where they are with the application process.
- ✓ Title the email with a professional headline (see templates).
- ✓ For example: “Office Assistant Position #1234: Follow up from Interview on Friday January 1, 2026”.
- ✓ Start by expressing your gratitude for the interview, advise the interviewer that you are following up to see if they have decided. Include 2-3 sentences about why you feel you would be a good fit and close the email by reiterating how you appreciate them taking the time to meet with you and look forward to hearing back from them soon.

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Further Discussion

Questions to Ask Your Mentor

- ✓ How much time do you spend preparing for an interview?
- ✓ What kinds of questions have you gotten in previous interviews?
- ✓ Are there any interview questions you struggle with?
- ✓ How do you avoid being nervous and stay confident during an interview?
- ✓ Have you ever been an interviewer? If so, what is something you looked for or noticed about the candidate? What did you appreciate?

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Action Items Before Next Session

Before Session 7

- ✓ Practice STAR answers for at least five common interview questions using ‘Worksheet: STAR Practice’ before the next session. Have at least five stories of past experiences written down prior to having an interview.

- ✓ Mark Session 6 as complete on the Student Portal

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What to do After an Interview

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https://www.forbes.com/sites/jacquelynsmith/2014/02/12/10-things-to-do-when-you-dont-hear-back-after-a-job-interview/?sh=285b41c41714

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